



Practice 1

Write a letter of enquiry for leather purses, bags, and other goods, asking for all details regarding variety, quality, colour, price list, etc. for a shop you are opening in a developing node of your city. Use the modified block form for your letter.

more information. We seek help from these people in a slightly different form of enquiry letter. Unsolicited enquiry letters must be constructed more carefully, because recipients of unsolicited letters of enquiry are not ordinarily prepared to handle such enquiries. Exhibits 15.9 and 15.10 are samples of letters of enquiry (solicited and unsolicited).



Another sample of a solicited letter of enquiry is given in the CD.

Reply to enquiry letters

Letters of enquiry must be replied to promptly to maintain healthy and pleasant business relationships. If the enquiry is from an established customer, appreciate their effort. If the enquiry is from a prospective customer, let your reply reflect that you are glad to receive the enquiry and express the hope that this new relationship will last long. The reply should address all the points referred to in the letter of enquiry clearly and concisely. The terms of payment must be stated, if applicable, in the reply, so that there is no room for confusion. Keep the reply brief and to the point (see Exhibit 15.11). Some more sample replies to enquiry letters are given in the CD.



Letters of quotation

A quotation is similar to a letter of enquiry or is a promise to supply goods on the given terms. It is not obligatory to buy goods for which a quotation is requested and suppliers never quote the prices for goods that they cannot supply. Therefore the quotation must be reasonable.

While requesting a quotation, the buyer must also enquire about the additional charges of transportation and insurance, as it becomes difficult to include them later. Exhibit 15.12 is an example of a typical quotation letter. Refer to the CD for tender letters, which are another type of quotation letters, with more examples.



Order Placement Letters

An order is a request for something to be made, supplied, or served. Some companies have their own printed forms for placing orders. These forms are pre-numbered for easy reference. The printed details ensure that no important information is missed out. However, small-scale companies do not use printed forms and place orders by writing letters. An order placement letter should be written very clearly and accurately, including the complete description of the goods required, quantities, price, catalogue number, delivery requirements, and the terms of payment as agreed by both the parties. Exhibit 15.13 is a sample of an order placement letter. Refer to the CD for more samples.



Claim Letters

A claim (a formal complaint) or an adjustment request (a claim settlement) is made when a company's product or service is not satisfactory. Although a complaint could be lodged over